Territory of India



There are important differences between Union of States and Territory of India. Union of State refers to the twenty eight states and Central Government. Territory of India means:

1. Twenty Eight States
2. Nine Union Territories
3. Acquired Territory (Any territory acquired by India like Pondicherry, Daman Diu after they became part of India and before they were made Union Territories)

Unitary or Non-Federal Features of Indian Constitution

Indian Constitution differs greatly from the concept of federalism followed in the classical federal Constitutions like the United States

1. Single Constitution

India possesses only one Constitution that caters to the needs of administration both in the Centre and States. Like the United States the individual States possess their own Constitution in addition to the national Constitution.

2. Single Citizenship

There is only one citizenship, exists in India, i.e. national citizenship. In the United States the citizens are endowed with both national and State citizenships.

3. Flexibility of Constitution

Indian Constitution is partially flexible. Some of the provisions of the Constitution can be carried out by a simple majority in the Parliament.

4. No Right to Existence for States

Our Constitution doesn't recognize the right of the States to name and existence. The union parliament can change the nomenclature and territorial identity of the States through an ordinary law. The articles 3 and 4 of the Constitution provide the procedure for the creation of new States and abolition of the existing States. An ordinary bill is introduced in either House of the Parliament for creating a new State or changing the name on the recommendation of the President. The bill is discussed and passed in Parliament leading to the creation of new States. A simple majority in Parliament is the requirement for reshaping the identity of the States.



Activity

Do you know that Sikkim was once called an Associate State of India?

5. Anti-Federal nature of Rajya Sabha

There are three reasons and areas where critics have criticized it as being against the States' rights and federal spirit of the Constitution.

There is no equality principle followed in the distribution of seats in the Council of States. The seats are distributed on the basis of population of the individual States. The most populous State of Uttar Pradesh has 31 seats whereas the smaller States like Nagaland have only one seat. But in any ideal federalism there should be equality of seat distribution in the upper house as seen in the United States where all the fifty State have two seats each in the

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